



At KRBL, innovation is a never ending process. It is the amongst the proud few to be actively associated with Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR), Ministry of Agriculture, Government of India, and has participated in their continuous endeavor to understand and improve the Basmati attributes further.

■ THE SEEDS OF SUCCESS

"Milled Rice is only as good as the paddy that is procured" - this is the reason KRBL Ltd. lays so much stress on R&D, and seed multiplication and distribution. KRBL owns a 700 acre seed farm wherein its scientists and extension workers toil to produce the best quality seeds under Quality Seeds Development and Improvement Programme (QSDIP). The top pedigree is selected and processed in an in-house seed preparation and packing plant. KRBL guarantees optimum germination and quality, as a result KRBL seeds are in higher demand than any other variety. The seeds are sold to farmers along with complete support from its Agri Division. This ensures production of paddy with the optimum levels of generic purity and aroma and also other specific basmati qualities..

■ INDIA'S LARGEST BASMATI CONTRACT FARMING PROGRAMME

Contract farming programme (CFP) was started in late 90's, with a view to ensure quality production of basmati and, at the same time, to enable the farmer to make a respectable livelihood, so that his interest to produce basmati is kept alive.

KRBL considers the farmer as the most important and fundamental link of the basmati value chain. Hence, when the company got into CFP, it evolved and established a true economic model of public-private partnership in contract farming.

KRBL today is proud to be the pioneer of the largest Basmati CFP, covering a vast area of over 100,000 acres and association of 65,000 farmers which is under its constant surveillance right from the stage of sowing of the paddy till the harvest.

A full - fledged Agri Services Division with a team of more than 80 people is dedicated to the task of providing proper extension services to the farmers. At the time of harvest, KRBL procurement team assists the farmers in storage and gives them the option to either sell to KRBL at pre-committed prices or at new market prices in KRBL owned auction yards.

■ OLD IS GOLD

Basmati needs a minimum ageing of 12 - 18 months, so as to flower in all its unique and special attributes. Hence, one has to plan two years in advance. The paddy purchased one season is kept in store for minimum one year and then is shipped out covering a span the whole of next year.

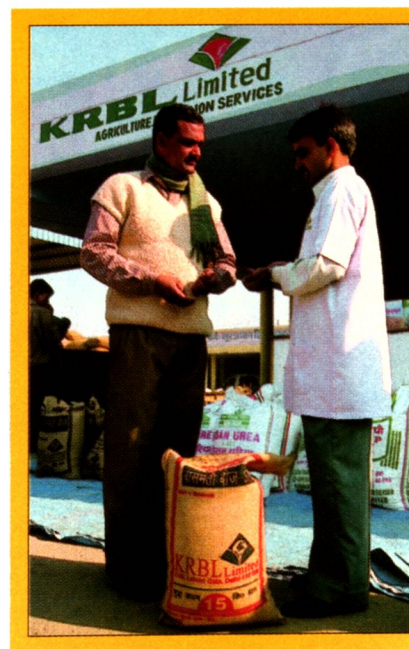
Ageing is done in a very scientific manner and the period of aging varies from not only between varieties but also crop season to the other. The decision to age in a

particular form for a specific time is derived after years of intrinsic understanding the respective varieties. This systematic process of storage management delivers the most optimum results to achieve guaranteed consistent quality in a sustained manner.

■ THE LARGEST MILLERS OF RICE IN THE WORLD

KRBL provided a platform to world class rice machinery giants such as Buhler, Sortex, Cimbria and others to automatized rice milling industry in India. Today KRBL has a milling capacity of 195 MT per hour and investment of over US \$ 100 million.

KRBL's rice making facility is the most advanced in the country with world-beating technologies. Equipped with Networked Soft Logic system, KRBL has achieved 100 percent automation. Meticulous planning, detailing and control over each stop of processing - cleaning, drying, milling, polishing, grading, sorting, weighing and packaging - have enabled KRBL to get closer to their vision of achieving zero-defect quality.



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